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CUSTOMER PERCEPTION AND SATISFACTION TOWARDS DIGITAL WALLETS IN INDIA

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ABSTRACT:

India's financial landscape has experienced a significant shift in recent years, largely driven by rapid technological advancement, increased use of smartphones, and supportive policy initiatives by the government. Digital wallets have emerged as a popular and easy medium of transaction, gradually reducing the reliance on physical cash. The preface of the Unified Payments Interface (UPI), along with major initiatives such as Digital India and demonetization, has accelerated the transition toward digital payment systems across both urban and rural areas. As a result, financial transactions become faster easier for users to use.

The target of the study is analysing customer perception and satisfaction for the utility of Indian digital wallets system. The design of the study is collecting samples form102 people who answered our question and from sources like journals and reports. We found that digital wallets are easy to use and it save times and make payment easily. People use wallets for lots of things like paying bills buying things online and sending money to others. Digital wallet is more popular with people and people who work. Many people don't like digital wallets because they don't easily trust with online usage, especially in rural areas. Digital wallets are important for India economy.

Keywords : Digital wallets, Perception, satisfaction, payment, upi, mobile transactions

Introduction –

The way people do transactions has changed a lot because of technology. In India the system of paying has grown very fast in period of times. Government has also made initiative to make digital wallets implemented in India. Digital wallet has become very popular in India. People make more often uses of digital payment as it easy for use and customer doesn't need to carry cash.

Digital wallet let people keep money on their phone or computer and use it to buy things without needing cash or going to the bank. You can use wallets to do lots of things, like shop online, buy tickets, send money to funds.

The turning point in Indian digital payment journey was the demonetization factor implemented in 2016, which made the crowd to switch from cash transactions to digital mediums. They have things like Digital India. They are trying to get more people to use banks and stuff. They also started something called Unified Payments Interface or UPI for short. That has really helped people use digital payments. Businesses like wallets too. People are happier, with the service they get. More and more small stores and local vendors are starting to use payments. This is making digital wallets more useful for people to use.

Despite wallets becoming more popular they still have some problems. The usage of digital wallets is not familiar and easy to several users. Problems like failed transactions and poor internet connectivity also stop people from using wallets. What customers think about wallets is very important for their success. Digital wallets have to work and meet customer needs to succeed.



Objectives and Scope

The objective is to evaluate the satisfaction of customers with digital wallets and to influence the customer for continued usage. The research is trying customers are facing issues regarding digital wallets.

Research should be helpful for the people who make wallets, banks and the government. India is trying to use cash and digital wallets will be a big part of this change. Digital wallets will play a role; in changing the way money works in India and making sure everyone is included. India is going through a change in the way people deal with money. This change started happening fast after the government decided to take some big bills out of circulation in 2016. There are a kind of digital wallets.

Importance of the Research

The scrutiny of customer perception and satisfaction toward digital wallets holds significant weight in the present digital era. Firstly, it gives us the reaction and behaviour of the people towards usage of wallets payment. Secondly it finds what matters to customers like if it's easy to use, secure, reliable and convenient. This study helps digital wallet companies improve their services to match what customers want.

Overview

The introduction of Technology has made people do daily tasks easily in several fields. They used to use cash for everything. E-wallets are being used all over the word for easy fast and precise payment. Digital wallets are popular now. You can keep money on your phone. Make payments right away. E-wallets are one of the payment mediums.

Growth

Regular usage of Digital wallets included paying bills adding money to our phones, online shopping, buying tickets and sending money to our friends. When the government stopped using currency people started using digital money a lot more. . Digital wallets make it easy for us to do transactions, with digital money and that is why digital wallets are so popular. People do online shopping and bill payments using wallets. The UPI and digital India initiative helps people to do transactions digitally. People are now using wallets a lot more because of these developments. Digital wallets are becoming very popular. These developments are a big reason for this.

Digital Wallets Advantages

We can use them to pay for things quickly. This means we do not have to carry cash with us all the time. Digital wallets are also very safe. We do not have to worry about someone stealing our money. We can see what we have spent our money on. Sometimes we even get money back when we use wallets. Digital wallets work well with our bank accounts. All these things make digital wallets very nice to use. That is why people of all ages like using wallets.

Roles in Business

From a business point of view digital wallets help cut costs make things run smoother and make customers happier. Small shops and local sellers are using payment methods more often. This is making digital transactions happen more in both cities and towns.

Digital payments are getting popular. People like using them to buy stuff. We are moving towards a cashless economy where people prefer making payments of using cash. Digital payments are how people want to make transactions. People are choosing payments, over cash. Digital wallets are making it easy.

Challenges faced

There are both advantages and disadvantages of digital wallets. One of the issues that people are doubting in digital payment is information security. They get really frustrated when things do not work the way they should like when a payment does not go through or the server is down. The internet connectivity is one of the issues in e wallet system and many users are not familiar with the interface of e-wallet system.

Importance of Customer Satisfaction

Customer perception is really important for digital wallet platforms to succeed. It is about the experience of the customers after using e wallet system. The good feeling while using e-wallet platform leads to reusage of the customers and promotion of the platform. On the hand, bad experiences with digital wallet platforms can make customers stop using digital wallet platforms. So digital wallet platforms need to understand what customers think and feel about wallet platforms. This helps digital wallet platforms improve their services and make customers happier with wallet platforms.

Role of Demographic Factors

Educated and younger people are more familiar with e-payments. . Older people may struggle with wallets because of less upgradation with knowledge .

Understanding these differences helps in developing targeted strategies to promote digital payment adoption.

Main purpose of this research

Purpose is to analyse customer digital wallet regarding digital wallets . People use wallets in ways. We came to know what makes people use wallets and if they're happy with them. We also came to know that people are facing some issues during use wallets. The study looks at how old someone's amount of rupee they are making and where they live to see if it also affect customer at what level they use their wallet. This helps us understand how people behave when they make payments.

Review of literature

The model shows that both what individuals think and their surroundings are important. Some studies focus on inclusion and say that digital solutions need to be cheap and easy to use **fto** regular financial services. Research consider government has helped a lot in promoting payments in India by making good policies. Some studies say that getting cashback and rewards makes people use wallets more often. Security problems and technical issues approach people to use limited . People are freely use for transactions are fast the service is good and support is available.

Research Gap

The research states that these gaps with a plan that includes looking at user details how they use digital wallets, what they think, how happy they are and their feedback.

Research structure

Research design is like a roadmap that guides us to gather, measure and examine data to reach our study objectives. It ensures that we conduct our research in an orderly manner. For our study "A Comprehensive

Study on Customer Perception and Satisfaction Towards Digital Wallets in India" we are using a combination of research design..

The study mainly uses data who use wallets. It uses math tools to make sure the findings are accurate. Many papers study act and feel when purchasing things do it this way This method is okay for studies, on what people like. Do when using digital wallets.

TYPES OF RESEARCH

The present study is following research approaches:

Descriptive Research:

This method explains customer behaviour , usage patterns, and satisfaction levels related to digital wallets. It helps to find out what people like how often they use something and what affects their choices. It also shows us what people prefer how frequently they use a product or service and what factors influence their decisions. We can see what people like. How often they use it. The factors which effect the people option are also considered. It is, about understanding user preferences how often they use something. What factors affect their choices.

Research That Makes Sense:

This way of doing things is about looking at the information we have and trying to understand it by using things like charts and seeing what percentage of people think or feel a certain way.

Quantitative Research:

This study is about numbers because we are using information that people gave us through questions that we asked in a way and then we use special methods to analyze those numbers.

Survey-Based Research:

We did this research by asking people questions directly so we could hear what they think and what they have been through.

How We Get Our Information We got our information from two places.

Primary Data

We got some of our information by asking people questions through a special online survey. We made sure to ask a variety of questions some with choices and some that asked people to rate things so we could consumer are satisfied are, with us.

Following questions are used for the following sections:

- Demographic details
- Usage patterns of digital wallets
- Customer perception
- Satisfaction levels
- Factors influencing usage
- Problems faced by users

Online surveys are widely preferred in such studies for CONVIENCE, less cost and ability to get a large number of responses over short period.

Secondary Data

This data gathered from sources that're trustworthy such as Research journals, Published articles, Government reports, Central bank reports, Books and academic studies, websites. This secondary data is really helpful in building a framework for our theory what many people researched in the past. It also helps us find gaps in the studies that already exist. The way we chose the people to participate in our study is called convenience sampling. This means we picked people who were available and willing to take part. **This is a way to** do things in academic research because or resources. Although it show some downsides it lets us collect data quickly from people who're relevant to our study. We got responses, from 102 people who took part in our study. These people come from all sorts of backgrounds included Self-employed individuals. This mix of people helps us get a lot of opinions and understand how different groups of people behave when it comes to secondary data and our study.

Targeted population

The target population includes:

- Individuals above 18 years of age
- Smartphone users
- Users of online payment systems
- Digital wallet users in India

The study focuses on commonly used digital wallet platforms such as:

- Google Pay
- PhonePe
- Paytm
- Amazon Pay

These platforms represent some kind digital payment ecosystem in India.

RESEARCH INSTRUMENT

Question has been prepared as the main research instrument. It includes:

- Multiple-choice questions
- Likert scale questions
- Demographic questions

This method helps in capturing the intensity of user opinions effectively.

DATA ANALYSIS TOOLS

I looked at the collected data. Used simple statistical tools to understand it. These tools included: Pie charts, Bar graphs, percentage. Basic statistical testing The collected data is easier to understand when I mainly use help me present the collected data clearly and make the interpretation of the collected data easier.

HYPOTHESIS

It the following idea: The digital wallet users don't have any correlation with their age group and at which certain stage they like the service. The age group of wallet users really does not show any change and their happiness level, with the service.

METHODOLOGY

The way we did this study is really straightforward. We wanted to know what person thought about wallets. So, we asked them many questions to know what is joyful and do not like about wallets. We made a list of questions and people answered them. We asked about who they're how they use digital wallets and if they will keep using them. We found out many people who use wallets are young and have jobs. This tells us that digital wallets are really popular with people who know a lot about technology and are comfortable using it. Digital wallets are something that people like to use. They are used by many with technology.

This study show some facts that there are ease of use, convenience, security, trust, rewards, and customer support. These variables important influencing customer satisfaction and continued usage. This show user are generally satisfied with transaction speed and ease of use, while concerns remain regarding security and reward benefits.

RESEARCH MODEL

The research model is designed to identify the relationship between customer perception factors and satisfaction levels.

Independent Variables:

- Ease of use
- Time-saving
- Security
- Trust
- Convenience
- Rewards and cashback
- Customer support
- Merchant acceptance

Dependent Variable:

- Customer satisfaction

Outcome Variables:

- Continued usage intention
- Recommendation behavior

The model suggests that customer perception factors influence satisfaction, which affects future usage and recommendation.

HYPOTHESIS DEVELOPMENT

Based on the research model, the following hypothesis is formulated:

- **H₀:** Merchant acceptance does not affect customer satisfaction.
- **H₁:** Merchant acceptance significantly affects customer satisfaction.

SIGNIFICANCE OF RESEARCH MODEL

The research model plays an important role in:

- Identifying key factors affecting satisfaction
- Understanding user perception
- Analyzing adoption behavior
- Highlighting areas for improvement
- Providing recommendations for better services

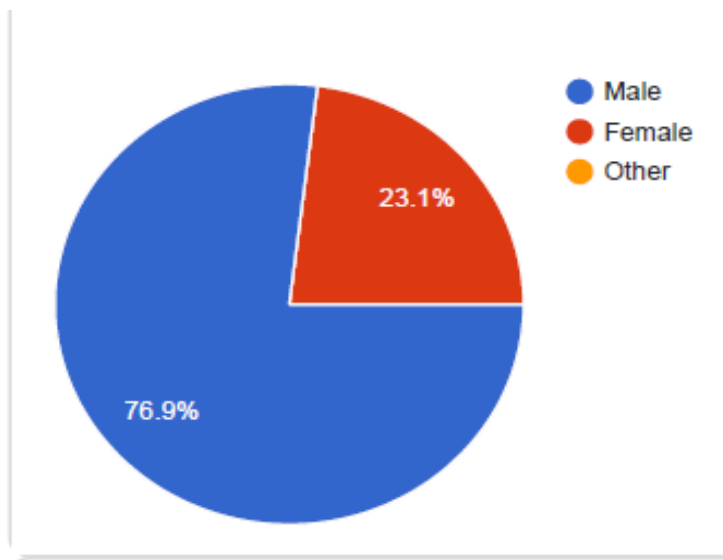
The findings widely accepted, and users generally show a positive side their usage. However, making security better making networks more reliable and improving reward systems can make users happier. These improvements are important. Security is a deal for users. They want to feel safe. Networks need to work too. Users get frustrated with down networks. Reward systems also matter. Users like to feel appreciated. So better security, reliable networks and improved rewards will make users more satisfied. It is, about the user experience.

Data Analysis & Findings

Data analysis is important when we do research because it helps us understand the information we have collected and make sense of it. Research depends on what people told us when they filled out a Google Form. We got answers from 102 people who took the survey. We looked at the information we got and used percentages and tables to make sense of the data from the Google Form and understand what it means about the data, from the survey.

Q1. Gender

Gender	Number of Responses	Percentage
Male	78	76.9%
Female	24	23.1%
Total	102	100%

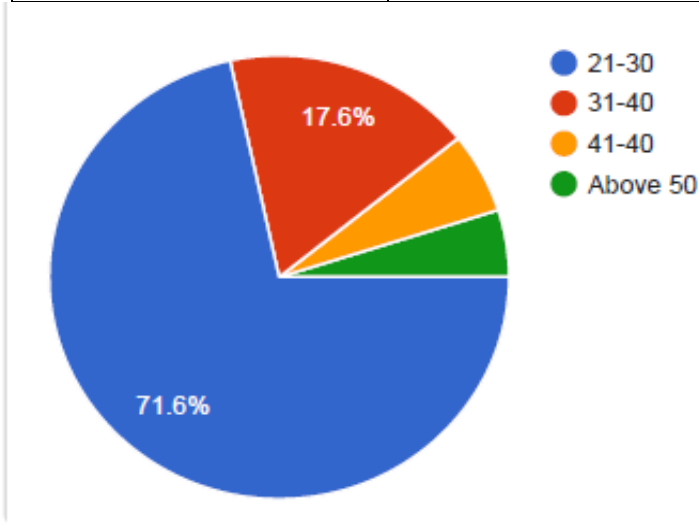


The table tells us that most of the people who answered the survey are men. 76.9% To be exact. On the hand 23.1% are women. Youngsters where highly involved. The survey has people from both sides, men and women. More men answered the questions.

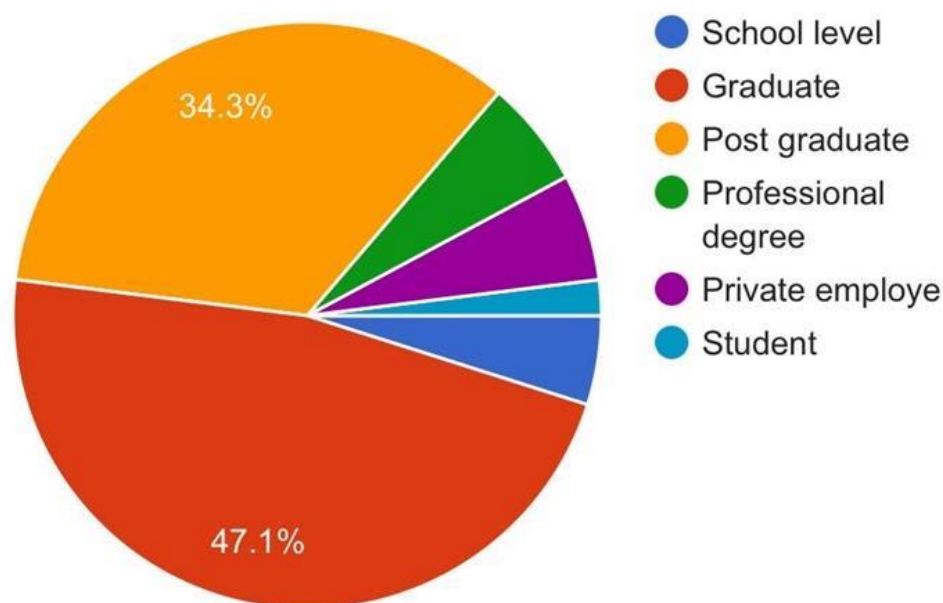
The survey found out that men use wallets a lot. This shows that men are really into using wallets. Women also used wallets and gave us some good ideas. The digital wallet users in the survey are mostly men. This is interesting because it means .

Q2. Age Group

Age Group	Number of Responses	Percentage
21–30 years	73	71.6%
31–40 years	18	17.6%
41–50 years	8	8%
Above 50	3	2.8%
Total	102	100%



People who use wallets are mostly between 21 and 30 years old. This means that digital wallets are used the most by adults.



Q3. Educational Qualification

Qualification	Number of Responses	Percentage
Graduate	48	47.1%
Postgraduate	35	34.3%
Professional Degree	10	9.8%
School Level	9	8.8%
Total	102	100%

Interpretation:

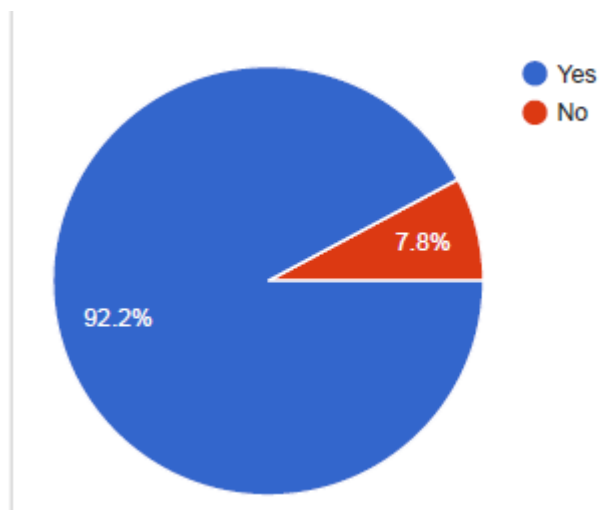
The data indicates that responses have attained graduate or postgraduate qualifications. This singel users are highly educated, informed and aware of digital payment systems compared to those with lower levels of education.

Finding:

The higher education levels contribute to greater usage and acceptance.

Q4. Do You Use Digital Wallets?

Response	Number of Responses	Percentage
Yes	94	92.2%
No	8	7.8%
Total	102	100%



Interpretation:

A large no of responses use digital wallets.

Finding:

Wallets are widespread acceptance.

Findings

Following research state that majority of respondents are female (78.4%), suggesting active participation and strong adoption of digital wallet services among women users. It is further observed that the dominant user group falls within the age bracket of 21–30 years, highlighting that young adults uses these platforms due to their greater familiarity with smartphones and digital technologies.

Large person of respondents (92%) reported using digital wallets, which clearly reflects the rapid acceptance and growing dependence on cashless payment systems in India.

PROBLEMS FACED

This research state that people trouble when they use wallets. Major problems are that the internet connection is not good. This makes it hard to do transactions. Sometimes they just stop working. The servers that digital wallets use also have errors and this happens a lot. When this happens, it takes a time to do things, or the service is not available for a little while. Digital wallets also have a problem when the banks servers are not working. This is especially bad when many people are trying uses wallets in identical time. Sometimes this means that payments do not go through. People also need to have an internet connection to use digital wallets. This is a limitation because digital wallets do not work properly without the internet. These problems are worse, in places where the internet's not very good. This makes it hard for people to use wallets and it bars them to use this digital wallet not reliable. Digital wallets have a lot of problems. This is why people do not like to use them sometimes.

CONCLUSION

The study called "A Comprehensive Study on Customer Perception and Satisfaction Towards Digital Wallets in India" seen at how the crowd behaves to use wallets, what they think of them and the amount of satisfaction having with them. When we looked at what people said and the results it is clear that digital wallets are now a part of how we do financial things. More people having smartphones, better internet and knowing more about things have helped make digital wallets popular. We concluded that most people who use wallets are between 21 and 30 years old. This brings us to like the point using wallets as they are familiar with technology. We also saw that a lot of women are using wallets, it concludes that more youngers are using digital things. However, some problems still exist. For example, the internet not. Servers not working are issues. People need the internet to use wallets, so these things need to be made better.

With these problems people trust digital wallets and want to keep using them. This state that person who using wallets. Wallets will play a role in helping India have less cash and more people involve economy. Digital wallets essential in India. People like using wallets. So digital wallets will keep being used by people in the future. People, like easy to access. Digital wallets help people do things. This is why people will keep using wallets. Digital wallets will be used by people for a time because people like using them and they are helpful.

FUTURE SCOPE OF THIS RESEARCH

This application is useful in digital payment system. There is much more to explore regarding improvement of digital payment system. The fields like AI and block chain system needs to be researched more to keep digital payments secured. The degree of change in digital payment system is high so comparison between several wallet providers is easy so that we can identify what customers prefer. One more dimension to be explored is how digital wallet help people with less money and limited exposure to bank. Digital wallets also let us know people where spend money plan their finances, so we should look into that more. Digital wallets are really important so we need to keep studying them to understand how they work and how they can help people.

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